the Agra-Lucknow Expressway. Of the 12 expressways now, the Yogi Adityanath government is focusing more on the Purvanchal Expressway, the Bundelkhand Expressway and the Ganga Expressway, all UPEIDA projects.

PURVANCHAL EXPRESSWAY, GORAKHPUR LINK

The 341-km long Purvanchal Expressway, inaugurated by PM Modi in November 2021, is one of the biggest completed infrastructure projects of the Uttar Pradesh government. The project was announced by then chief minister Akhilesh Yadav as the Lucknow-Azamgarh-Ballia Expressway in May 2015. Later, its route was changed to Lucknow-Azamgarh-Ghazipur by the BJP government. "The CM himself belongs to Purvanchal, he focused on its development as it's a new lifeline for business in eastern UP," says an official in Yogi's office. It cost an estimated Rs 22,496 crore. The six-lane expressway starts from Chandsarai village in Lucknow district on the Lucknow-Sultanpur road and ends at Haidaria village on National Highway 31 in Ghazipur district. Travel time from Lucknow to Ghazipur has now halved: from seven hours to three-and-a-half hours. The districts of eastern UP—especially Lucknow, Barabanki, Amethi, Ayodhya, Sultanpur, Ambedkar Nagar, Azamgarh, Mau and Ghazipur—will be the main beneficiaries. In the same area, the under-construction Gorakhpur-link expressway will connect Jaitpur village in Gorakhpur with Salarpur village on the Purvanchal Expressway in Azamgarh district, reducing travel time between Gorakhpur and Lucknow to three hours from five.

BUNDELKHAND EXPRESSWAY

The Bundelkhand Expressway will connect Chitrakoot in the Bundelkhand region with the Agra-Lucknow Expressway near Etawah. It starts near Bharatkoop at the Jhansi-Prayagraj National Highway 35 in Chitrakoot district. The project has been completed in 28 months—eight months ahead of its deadline, claims the government. The four-lane expressway, which can be expanded to six lanes, will pass through seven districts—Chitrakoot, Banda, Mahoba, Hamirpur, Jalaun, Auraiya and Etawah. Officials say the total cost of the project is estimated to be about Rs 15,000 crore. Significantly, the expressway will link the Bundelkhand area with New Delhi through the Agra-Lucknow Expressway and Yamuna Expressway. Chitrakoot is now just 6.5 hours away from the national capital. Earlier, it used to take 9-10 hours. For parched Bundelkhand, the project can be an economic blessing too. The central government's Uttar Pradesh Defence Industrial Corridor has a node in Chitrakoot; the others are in Agra, Aligarh, Jhansi, Lucknow and Kanpur. CM Yogi Adityanath says, "The Bundelkhand Expressway will add a new dimension to the economy of the region and the rest of Uttar Pradesh. This *vikas ka expressway* will ensure seamless connectivity and open up new possibilities for the people of Bundelkhand." With Chitrakoot within reach of

INVITING ALL WHEELS

UP'S MESH OF EXPRESSWAYS

1 YAMUNA EXPRESSWAY
165 km (Noida to Agra)
Started by the Mayawati government, inaugurated by Akhilesh Yadav in 2012

2 LUCKNOW-AGRA EXPRESSWAY
302 km (Lucknow to Agra)
Inaugurated by Akhilesh Yadav in 2016

3 PURVANCHAL EXPRESSWAY
340 km (Lucknow to Ghazipur)
Started as Lucknow-Azamgarh-Ballia Expressway during Akhilesh's regime; inaugurated by PM Narendra Modi in 2021 after route changes

4 BUNDELKHAND EXPRESSWAY
296 km (Chitrakoot to Etawah)
Project announced by Yogi Adityanath, inaugurated by PM Modi in July. Completed in record 28 months

5 GANGA EXPRESSWAY
594 km (Meerut to Prayagraj)
Project announced by Yogi Adityanath, under construction

6 GORAKHPUR LINK EXPRESSWAY
91 km (Gorakhpur to Azamgarh, merging with Purvanchal Expressway)
Project announced by Yogi Adityanath, under construction

7 LUCKNOW-KANPUR EXPRESSWAY
62 km (Lucknow to Kanpur)
Foundation stone laid by Rajnath Singh and Nitin Gadkari, construction yet to start

● CM Yogi Adityanath has had a major role in the conception of these expressways

The ambitious Ganga Expressway will be access-controlled and have eight lanes. Running along the Ganga, it will cover 12 districts and connect west and east UP